

March

17

461 CE

St Patrick

Christian bishop St Patrick is thought to have died on this day. Now the patron saint of Ireland, he is known for using the three leaves of the shamrock plant to describe the nature of the Holy Trinity – God, Jesus, and the Holy Spirit. The anniversary of his death is today recognized as St Patrick's Day – an annual celebration of Irish culture.



Also on this day

1861 The Kingdom of Italy was officially proclaimed in Turin after a decade of revolution. Victor Emmanuel was crowned its first king.

1958 *Vanguard I*, the first solar-powered satellite, was launched by the USA. It is the oldest human-made object orbiting Earth.

1992 A majority of white voters in South Africa voted "Yes" in a public vote to end apartheid.



1969

Israel's Iron Lady

Golda Meir was elected prime minister, becoming the first woman to lead Israel. In power for five years, she led her nation through the 1973 Yom Kippur War and became known as the Iron Lady of Israeli politics.

Born this day

1902 Alice Greenough Orr, first woman professional rodeo performer in the USA. She won four world saddle bronc championships.

1969 Alexander McQueen, British fashion designer. McQueen launched his career as head designer at French fashion house Givenchy and later went on to establish his own luxury brand.

2001 Eden Project

A giant greenhouse of eight connected domes, called the Eden Project, opened to visitors in Cornwall, UK. The domes now house about 5,000 different plant species from around the world.

